NETHERBLOOM

Book of Remembrance



Child of the Last Flame

The old grave-texts told the dead: do not drink from Lethe; find the spring of Memory. This Book is that spring.

Keeping the Book

The Book has one page per Reach. Each page has four slots, **Place**, **Person**, **Deed** and **Feeling**, which fill a sentence about the soul's life.

You may **inscribe** a card when it Resonates, if its memory's slot is still empty on the current page. A **Key Memory** card may be inscribed whenever it is played face up. An inscribed card leaves the deck for good: you trade a useful card for a memory the soul will keep.

Chapter Blessing. When a page holds 3 memories (2 for the Garland Girl), the river grants the first of these that applies: mend a Fracture, drain Black Water, or return a forgotten card.

At the end, the Book is read aloud. Slots never filled read "...but this, the river has taken".

> Tuck an inscribed card into the well for its slot: slide its four corners under the slits. Slide it out again to reuse the card next game.

THE SOUL OF THIS BOOK

Child of the Last Flame

A small child alone in a doorway on the coldest night of the year, with a handful of little lights to sell and none sold. To keep warm she lights them one by one, and in each flame she sees something: a warm stove, a feast, and at last the one person who ever held her, coming to take her home.

Twist: Starts with 3 Light. The first Fracture in each Reach is ignored. Never drifts Adrift. She can forget 1 more card before she Fades. No harsh Mist.

Key Memory: *the one who used to hold me before she was gone*

One more little light, struck against the cold.



I · Who I Was

I was born near...

PLACE

...but this, the river has taken

I loved...

PERSON

...but this, the river has taken

I once...

DEED

...but this, the river has taken

and ever since I have carried...

FEELING

...but this, the river has taken

☐ Chapter Blessing

Keepsakes ☐ ☐ ☐

II · What I Did

At...

PLACE

...but this, the river has taken

before...



PERSON

...but this, the river has taken

I...



DEED

...but this, the river has taken

The price was...



FEELING

...but this, the river has taken

☐ Chapter Blessing

Keepsakes ☐ ☐ ☐

III · What I Carry

I go now, leaving...



forgiving...



unable to undo the day I...



holding only...



☐ Chapter Blessing

Keepsakes ☐ ☐ ☐

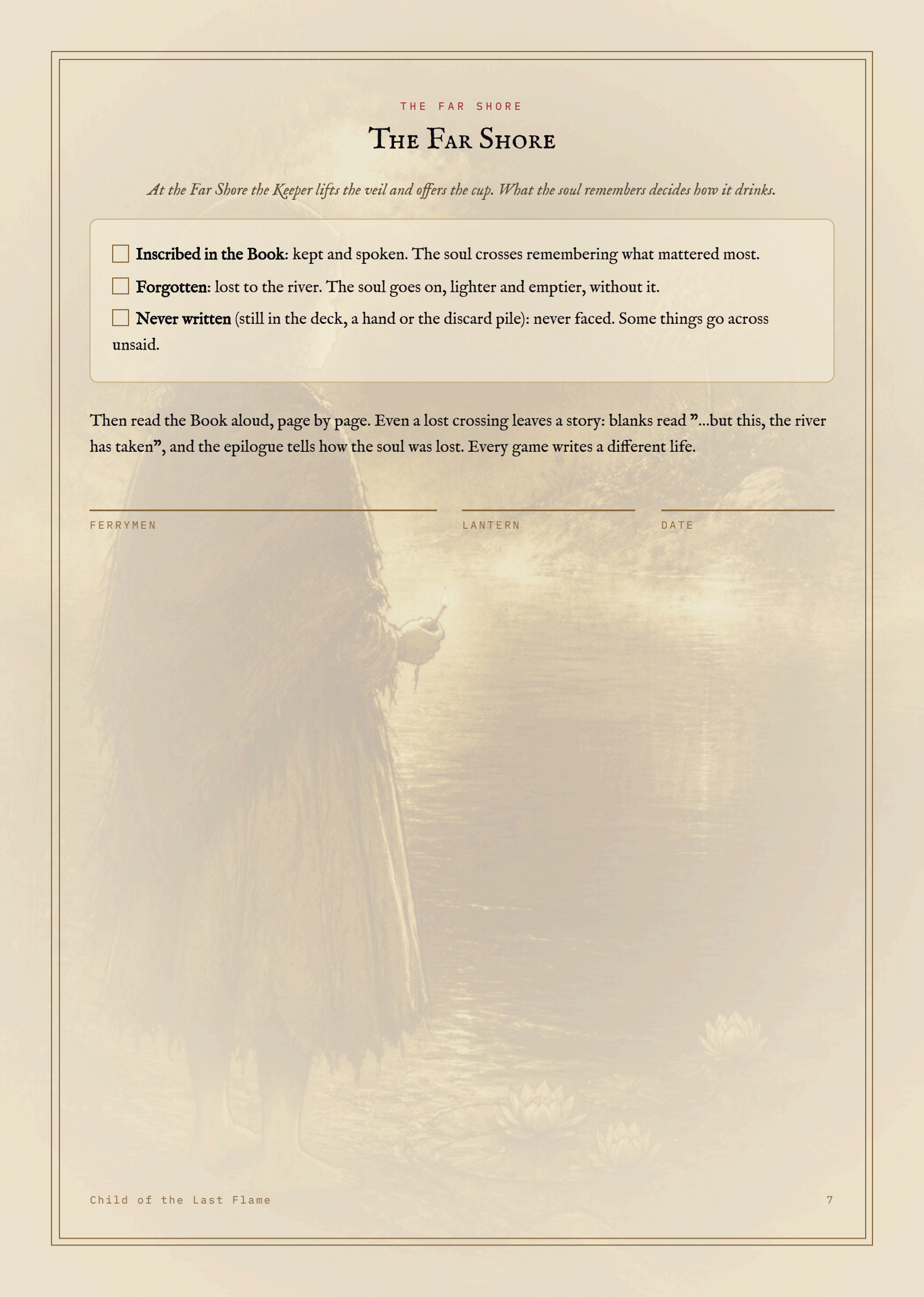
The Far Shore

At the Far Shore the Keeper lifts the veil and offers the cup. What the soul remembers decides how it drinks.

- ☐ **Inscribed in the Book**: kept and spoken. The soul crosses remembering what mattered most.
- ☐ **Forgotten**: lost to the river. The soul goes on, lighter and emptier, without it.
- ☐ **Never written** (still in the deck, a hand or the discard pile): never faced. Some things go across unsaid.

Then read the Book aloud, page by page. Even a lost crossing leaves a story: blanks read "...but this, the river has taken", and the epilogue tells how the soul was lost. Every game writes a different life.

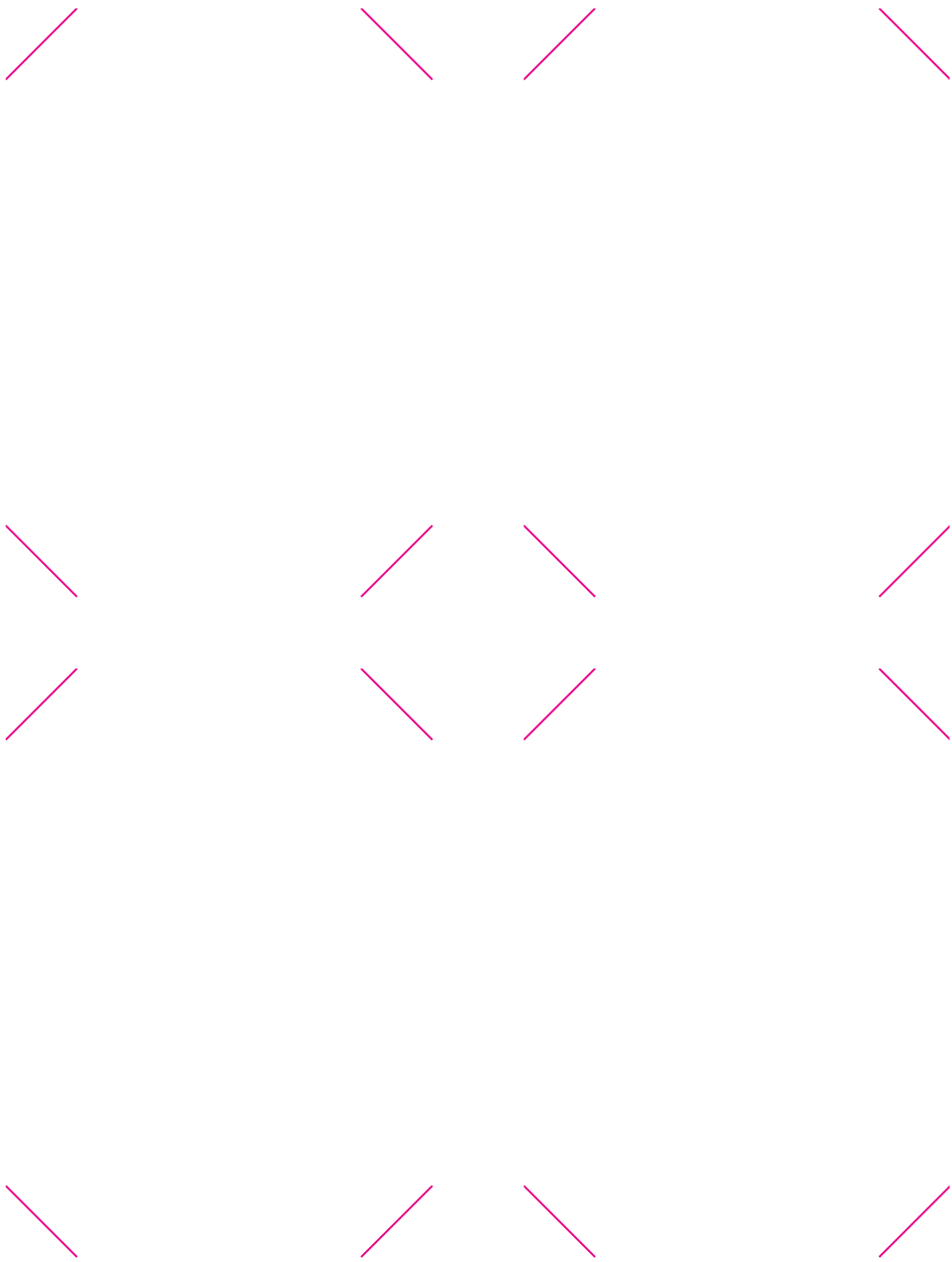
FERRYMEN _____ LANTERN _____ DATE _____





NETHERBLOOM

RALPH LAUXIE



DIE LINE · pages 4–6 · photo-corner slits (magenta), 11 mm diagonals at each corner of the four 66 × 91 mm wells